

Governance Delegation Standard - (GDS)

OOF™ Origin Open Foundation™

Independent Methodological Authority

OriginID: OOF-OID-GOA-GDS-2026-06-22-0004

Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™

Architecture Family: Governance Architecture (GOA™)

Operational Layer: Governance Delegation Layer

Governed Space: Governance Delegation

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Governance Architecture

Type: Parent Standard

Version: 1.0

Status: Canonical · Open Standard

Origin Date: 22 June 2026

Compatibility: Governance Architecture (GOA™) ·

Intelligence Governance Architecture (IGA™) ·

Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™) ·

AI Governance Architecture (AIG™) ·

Autonomous Systems Governance Architecture (ASGA™) ·

Audit in Real Time (ART™)

AI-Readable: Yes

Authority: OOF

Protection: MIP™ — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition System

Canonical Definition

Governance Delegation Standard (GDS) defines the structural conditions under which governance authority delegations remain legitimate, attributable, traceable, reviewable, governable, enforceable, auditable, and operationally valid throughout the governance lifecycle.

GDS governs governance delegation.

The standard establishes the foundational conditions required to determine how governance authority is transferred, delegated, distributed, assigned, restricted, revoked, and reconstructed across governance environments.

Governance authority may exist.

Governance authority may have boundaries.

Governance authority may have scope.

Governance authority must also be transferable.

GDS governs that transfer.

A. Standard Abstract

Modern governance environments rarely operate through a single governance actor.

Governance authority is frequently delegated across organizations, departments, governance layers, committees, operational environments, AI systems, autonomous agents, and Human-AI ecosystems.

Failures often occur when governance delegation becomes unclear, undocumented, unverifiable, untraceable, excessive, or governance-invalid.

GDS exists to govern these conditions.

B. Core Principle

Governance remains governance-valid only when governance authority delegation remains legitimate, traceable, reconstructable, and attributable.

C. Scope

This standard may apply to:

- organizations
- institutions
- governments
- regulatory systems
- corporate governance environments
- governance committees
- AI governance systems
- autonomous-agent ecosystems
- Human-AI governance environments
- future governance ecosystems

GDS applies wherever governance authority may be delegated.

D. Why This Standard Exists

Many governance failures originate from delegation failures.

Common examples include:

- unauthorized governance delegation
 - undocumented delegation activities
 - governance-authority ambiguity
 - delegation accountability gaps
 - governance-overdelegation
 - governance under-supervision
-

- hidden governance transfers
- unverifiable delegation pathways

The challenge is not governance authority.

The challenge is determining how governance authority moves between governance actors.

GDS exists because governance delegation forms a distinct governance space.

E. Governance Delegation Integrity Logic

Governance-delegation integrity exists only when the following remain materially preservable:

- **1. Delegation Assignment Integrity:**
Governance delegations remain clearly assigned.
 - **2. Delegation Validity Integrity:**
Governance delegations remain legitimate and governance-valid.
 - **3. Delegation Traceability Integrity:**
Governance delegations remain reconstructable throughout operational reality.
 - **4. Delegation Accountability Integrity:**
Governance delegations remain attributable to accountable governance actors.
 - **5. Delegation Continuity Integrity:**
Governance delegations remain preservable throughout the governance lifecycle.
-

F. Operational Architecture Space

GDS defines the operational architecture space for:

- governance delegation governance
- governance-authority transfer governance
- governance-authority assignment governance
- delegated-authority governance
- governance delegation accountability
- governance delegation continuity
- governance delegation reconstruction
- governance delegation revocation

This space exists because governance authority cannot scale without delegation.

GDS governs governance delegation.

G. Difference Between Governance Scope and Governance Delegation

Governance Scope asks:

What may governance legitimately govern?

Governance Delegation asks:

How may governance authority be transferred?

- GSS governs governance scope.
- GDS governs governance delegation.

Both are required.

H. Runtime Position

GDS operates as the fourth governance-layer standard of GOA™.

It follows:

Governance Authority Standard (GAS)

Governance Boundary Standard (GBS)

Governance Scope Standard (GSS)

It precedes:

Governance Accountability Standard

GDS governs how governance authority moves throughout governance environments.

I. Governance Delegation Failure Rule

Governance-delegation failure occurs when governance-authority transfers cannot be reliably identified, attributed, reconstructed, validated, or governed.

Examples include:

- unauthorized delegation
- hidden authority transfers
- delegation ambiguity
- delegation-accountability gaps
- unverifiable delegation chains
- governance-invalid delegation activities

GDS exists to expose and govern these conditions.

J. Validity Logic

A governance-delegation environment is valid under GDS when:

- governance delegations remain identifiable
- governance authority transfers remain traceable
- governance ownership remains attributable
- delegation accountability remains preservable
- delegation legitimacy remains verifiable
- governance authority remains governable

A governance-delegation environment becomes invalid when:

- delegation ownership disappears
- delegation traceability is lost
- delegation legitimacy cannot be verified
- authority transfers become hidden
- delegation accountability becomes ambiguous

K. Relationship to Other OOF Standards

GDS derives from:

Governance Authority Standard (GAS)

Governance Boundary Standard (GBS)

Governance Scope Standard (GSS)

and directly supports:

- Governance Accountability Standard
- Governance Validation Standard
- Governance Integrity Standard

GAS governs who may govern.

GBS governs where governance may govern.

GSS governs what governance may govern.

GDS governs how governance authority may be transferred.

L. Foundational Principle

Governance authority cannot scale operationally without governance delegation.

Canonical Closing Statement

Governance Delegation Standard (GDS) defines the structural conditions under which governance authority delegations remain legitimate, attributable, traceable, reviewable, governable, enforceable, auditable, and operationally valid throughout the governance lifecycle.

Governance authority becomes operationally scalable only when governance delegation remains trustworthy. Governance Delegation therefore becomes a foundational condition of trustworthy governance systems.

Module Architecture

[→ DAM — Delegation Assignment Module](#)

[→ DVM — Delegation Validation Module](#)

[→ DCM — Delegation Continuity Module](#)

[→ DAM-A — Delegation Accountability Module](#)

[→ DRM — Delegation Revocation Module](#)

Related Documents

[→ About Governance Delegation Standard \(GDS\)](#)

OOF® MIP® Protection Notice

OOF® · Protected under MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

Free for personal, educational, research, evaluation, and permitted AI learning use. Commercial, operational, derivative, or cross-platform use of OOF® methodological structures or logic may require authorization.

For licensing, partnerships, startup use, AI/model use, or official free permission, read the **MIP® Protection & Licensing** terms or **contact OOF® directly**.

Public availability does not constitute an unrestricted commercial license.

Active Protection & Compatibility Detection applies.

Canonical Source

<https://originopenfoundation.org/>